

INDIA GETS ITS FIRST WORLD CHAMPION IN ESPORTS

Ved 'Beezleboy' Bamb **clinched** the 2025 Pokémon World Championship at the Anaheim Convention Centre in California

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Esports in India has already had some remarkable chapters, from an Indian club partnering at the Esports World Cup to seeing the tricolour on the podium after Pavan Kampelli won bronze in eFootball at the Asian Esports Games.

Another chapter — a very significant one — was added to this legacy last month when 21-year-old Ved 'Beezleboy' Bamb clinched the 2025 Pokémon World Championship at the Anaheim Convention Centre in California. He became the country's first esports athlete to win a world championship, defeating Spain's Leo "P4T0M4N" Marín to script history.

The 'Beelzeboy' from Nagpur won the grand finals against P4T0M4N in a tight 3-2 series, earning USD 20,000, while P4T0M4N secured USD 15,000 as the runner-up. Brazil's LNDsRargef took third place with USD 13,000.

The youngster from Nagpur emerged from the Lower Bracket and faced P4T0M4N for the second time. To win the championship, Beelzeboy had to beat the Spanish

player twice: first to reset the bracket and then again to claim the title.

Beezelboy started playing the game in 2016 when Pokémon Go arrived in India and had finished fourth in the last edition of the tournament. He joined the North American esports organisation LAGr Gaming in September 2024 and has since proved his mettle in the title. He won the national title, competing against 256 players without a single loss, and remains the only international Pokémon player on the current active roster.

MANCHESTER TO LEIPZIG, HERE WE GO!

The summer of 2025 may have seen a major transfer from Leipzig to Manchester—with Benjamin Sesko joining Manchester United from RB Leipzig for GBP 74 million—but in esports, there was a major transfer in almost the opposite direction.

Donovan 'Tekkz' Hunt joined Leipzig after a two-year stint at Manchester City. A FIFAe Club World Cup

VALORANT RANKINGS



ABHIRUP
"LIGHTNINGFAST" CHOUDHURY



GANESH
"SKROSSI" GANGADHAR



SHRAVANA
"TECHNO" SAHOO



AMAN
"HOAX" YADAV



SAGNIK
"HELLFF" ROY